

UNIT 7 / Home and neighbourhood

Furniture and colours

Your goal: Describe furniture using colours and contrasting qualities.

01 Learn the idea

Build descriptions with a noun, sein and an adjective: Der Tisch ist braun. Common colours include rot, blau, grün, weiß and schwarz. Learn colours in short sentences rather than as isolated labels. The adjective stays unchanged after ist even when the noun has a different gender.

Use aber to contrast qualities: Das Sofa ist alt, aber bequem. Und adds another quality: Der Stuhl ist klein und leicht. Pronouns can replace a noun you have just named: der Tisch becomes er, die Lampe sie and das Sofa es. This gender link is grammatical, even for objects.

Words and phrases

German	English
Der Tisch ist braun.	The table is brown.
Die Lampe ist weiß.	The lamp is white.
Das Sofa ist bequem.	The sofa is comfortable.
Der Stuhl ist klein.	The chair is small.
Es ist alt, aber schön.	It is old but beautiful.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Wie findest du das Sofa?

What do you think of the sofa?

Ben

Es ist alt, aber bequem.

It is old but comfortable.

Mia

Ja, und die Lampe ist neu.

Yes, and the lamp is new.

Your real-life mission

Describe three pieces of furniture using a colour and one other quality. Replace one repeated noun with er, sie or es.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Der Tisch ist braun.” mean?

- A. The lamp is white.
- B. The table is brown.
- C. The sofa is comfortable.

2. What does “Die Lampe ist weiß.” mean?

- A. The sofa is comfortable.
- B. The chair is small.
- C. The lamp is white.

3. What does “Das Sofa ist bequem.” mean?

- A. The sofa is comfortable.
- B. The chair is small.
- C. It is old but beautiful.

4. Which pronoun replaces das Sofa?

- A. er
- B. es
- C. sie

5. What is new?

- A. The sofa
- B. The table
- C. The lamp

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - The table is brown.

“Der Tisch ist braun.” means “The table is brown.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - The lamp is white.

“Die Lampe ist weiß.” means “The lamp is white.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - The sofa is comfortable.

“Das Sofa ist bequem.” means “The sofa is comfortable.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - es

Sofa is neuter, so the matching singular pronoun is es.

5. C - The lamp

Mia says die Lampe ist neu.

One possible mission response

Der Tisch ist braun. Er ist groß. Die Lampe ist weiß. Das Sofa ist blau und bequem.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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